Fact File

Peruvian fishermen named the weather phenomenon El Nino meaning 'little boy' or 'New born Christ' and La Nina meaning 'Little girl' as the phenomenon was first noticed during Christmas time.

La Nina

La Nina is just the opposite to the condition of El Nino. When trade winds are strong, colder water up wells on the East Pacific Ocean, walker air circulation is confined to the west Pacific, wet condition in Southeast Asia and dry weather in South America is observed.

The difference in the atmospheric pressure between the west and east tropical Southern Pacific Ocean is referred to as Southern Oscillation. Meteorologists have established a close inter link between Southern Oscillation and occurrences of El Nino and La Nina events. The acronym **'ENSO'(El Nino Southern Oscillation)** is often used to study both the phenomena.

GLOSSARY

1. **Abyssal plains:** An extremely large, flat, under water plain on the deep ocean floor.
2. **Continental rise:** is area between the continental slope and the sea floor.
3. **Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ):** extends from the base line to a maximum of 200 nautical miles (370.4 km).
4. **Isthmus:** A narrow steep of land that connects two large land masses and separates two bodies of water.
5. **Hot spot:** An area is the mantle from where rocks melt and magma rises through circular to form volcano.
6. **Permafrost:** is the condition prevailing when water freezes above and below the ground, (including rock or soil) for more than two consecutive years
7. **Trace elements:** A chemical element present in minute amount in a particular sample or environment.
8. **Isohaline:** is an imaginary line drawn to join places having equal salinity
9. **Swell:** is a type of wind-generated waves that is not affected by the local wind.
10. **Reservoir:** A large lake use as a source of water supply

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